

Tuesday, 8 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Drizzle

20° 14°

BIRMINGHAM

Light rain

18° 13°

MANCHESTER

Heavy drizzle

16° 12°

GLASGOW

Rain

14° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **Talks aimed at resolving Stormont's budget deadlock have hit a snag, with parties saying the money on offer doesn't go far enough.**

Sir Chris Bryant arrived for discussions on Monday, but it seems there's still a significant gap to bridge. Northern Ireland's executive is facing tough financial decisions.

POLITICS · UK

- 2 **A new 'super-university' has been created in the UK, becoming the third largest higher education institution in the country.**

The London and South East University Group, or LASE, was formed amid a funding squeeze in the sector. It brings together several existing institutions.

EDUCATION · UK

- 3 **Tragedy on the roads as two people have been killed after a car hit a group of cyclists near Gravesend.**

Police have arrested three people in connection with the incident, which sent shockwaves through the local community. Investigations are ongoing to determine exactly what happened.

ACCIDENT · UK

- 4 **A convicted rapist who is already serving a life sentence may face even more assault charges, police have revealed.**

Zhenhao Zou was found guilty of raping ten women, but officers now believe he may have committed further crimes. This comes after a thorough review of past cases.

CRIME · UK

- 5 **After a lovely warm weekend, the weather across the UK is set to turn cooler, with wet and windy conditions forecast for the week.**

Many areas can expect to see rain and strong winds as a new weather front moves in. So, it's time to dig out those brollies again!

WEATHER · UK

What's coming up

1

Great news for fans of *The Inbetweeners*, as Netflix has confirmed a new film is on the way with the original cast returning!

The beloved coming-of-age sitcom stars are set to reprise their roles, bringing more hilarious antics to the big screen. It's been a long wait for this one!

ON AIR – Are you excited for more *Inbetweeners*? What are your favourite moments from the original series or films?
FILM · COMING SOON

2

From boy band stages to the racecourse, JJ Hamblett is swapping singing for saddles this week!

The former pop star is taking part in a charity horse race at Doncaster Racecourse on September 11th. It's quite a change of pace for him!

ON AIR – Would you ever try a completely different career for a good cause? What's the most unusual thing you've done for charity?
EVENT · THIS WEEK

3

The rumour mill is in overdrive about who will be the next James Bond, with an announcement potentially close!

Speculation has been building for months about Daniel Craig's successor, and fans are eager for answers. The iconic role is one of the most coveted in Hollywood.

ON AIR – Who do you think should be the next James Bond? What qualities does the new 007 need to have?
FILM · COMING SOON

4

Comedian Munya Chawawa is making a big leap from social media to Shakespeare, making his stage acting debut!

He's decided to 'jump ship' from creating online content to treading the boards in a classical play. It's a bold move for the popular satirist.

ON AIR – What do you think of comedians taking on serious acting roles? Who would you love to see try something completely different?
THEATRE · COMING SOON

5

The *Grand Tour* has a new trio taking the wheel, and they're hoping to prove the critics wrong!

A fresh set of presenters has replaced Jeremy Clarkson, Richard Hammond, and James May on the popular motoring show. They've got big boots to fill!

ON AIR – Do you think new presenters can ever truly replace beloved hosts? Who are your favourite TV presenting trios?
TV · COMING SOON

On the schedule

- In an incredible upset at the US Open, Zheng Qinwen has stunned Iga Swiatek, reaching the quarter-finals!**
Zheng won a set from 5-0 down for the second successive match, showing incredible resilience. It's been a truly remarkable run for her.

ON AIR – What's the most dramatic sporting comeback you've ever witnessed? Is there anything more exciting than an underdog winning?

TENNIS · THIS WEEK

- The Women's Super League made a thrilling return this weekend, with plenty of goals and new contenders emerging!**

Manchester City started strong, but new signings and improved squads across the league promise an exciting season. It's great to have the WSL back!

ON AIR – Did you watch any of the WSL games this weekend? Which team do you think will be the ones to watch this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

- Wigan Warriors captain Liam Farrell has announced he will retire at the end of the season, after a stellar 16-year career.**

Farrell has won 18 major honours during his time with Wigan, making him a true club legend. It's the end of an era for the rugby league star.

ON AIR – What makes a true club legend in sport? Which athletes do you admire for their loyalty to one team?

RUGBY · UK

- Get ready for some top-class golf as Europe prepares to host the United States in the 20th edition of the Solheim Cup!**

The prestigious women's team golf tournament will take place at Bernardus Golf in the Netherlands. It's always a fiercely contested event!

ON AIR – Are you excited for the Solheim Cup? Which European players are you hoping will shine this year?

GOLF · THIS WEEK

- Former Wales captain Ashley Williams and ex-Swansea boss Alan Sheehan have joined Craig Bellamy's Wales staff.**

They'll be part of the backroom team ahead of Wales' Nations League campaign, bringing a wealth of experience. It's a strong new line-up for the Dragons.

ON AIR – How important is it to have former players on the coaching staff? Does it bring a different perspective to the team?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that taking a moment to simply observe 'clouds' can significantly boost your mood.**
Researchers found that even a few minutes of cloud-gazing helped reduce stress and increase feelings of calm. Perhaps it's time to look up more often!
- 2 The delightful art of 'homemade greetings cards' is seeing a charming resurgence.**
People are rediscovering the joy and personal touch of crafting their own cards, making every message feel extra special for friends and family.
- 3 A quirky trend sees pet owners creating 'miniature obstacle courses' for their furry friends indoors.**
Using household items like cushions and tunnels, it's a fun way to keep pets entertained and active, especially on rainy days.
- 4 More people are embracing the simple pleasure of 'writing letters' to loved ones.**
In an age of instant messages, the slower, more thoughtful process of penning a letter offers a unique connection and a lovely surprise for the recipient.
- 5 The humble 'teatowel' is having a surprising moment in home decor.**
From quirky designs to elegant patterns, people are using them to add splashes of personality and colour to their kitchens beyond their practical use.
- 6 A fascinating report highlights the growing popularity of 'community garden projects' across the UK.**
These green spaces are bringing neighbours together, fostering new friendships, and providing fresh produce for local residents.
- 7 A new wave of 'board game cafes' is popping up, offering a cosy space for socialising.**
They provide a relaxed atmosphere where friends and families can enjoy a cuppa, a snack, and a good old-fashioned board game together.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of sparkling water will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: POURING A TINY BIT INTO A GLASS JUST TO WATCH THE BUBBLES FOR A MOMENT, BEFORE EVEN TASTING IT!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm bath, especially if it's a new bath bomb. What is it?

ANSWER: HOLDING THE BATH BOMB UNDER THEIR NOSE FOR A GOOD SNIFF, TRYING TO IMAGINE THE FRAGRANCE FILLING THE BATHROOM, BEFORE IT EVEN TOUCHES THE WATER.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' can just make you feel instantly happy or bring a smile to your face, even if it's something really ordinary?

What's that one unexpected sound that always brightens your day, whether it's the kettle whistling, birdsong, or the crunch of leaves underfoot?

- We all have that 'one household chore' that we secretly, or not so secretly, find quite satisfying to do, don't we, even if it's a bit mundane?

What's the chore that actually brings you a quiet sense of accomplishment or even a bit of joy when you've finished it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of pugs is officially called a 'grumble'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, which helps them identify edible plants.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest fish is the *Paedocypris progenetica*, found in Sumatra, measuring just 7.9 mm.
- The inventor of the frisbee was inspired by throwing pie tins from the 'Frisbie Pie Company'.
- An ostrich's eye is bigger than its brain.
- The British Royal Family officially owns all the swans on the River Thames.
- The 'smiley face' emoticon was invented in 1982 by computer scientist Scott Fahlman.
- There are more permutations of a standard deck of 52 playing cards than there are atoms on Earth.
- The original name for 'butterfly' was 'flutterby'.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.

On this day

Day 251 of the year, 114 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Adrian and Natalia of Nicomedia (Roman Catholic Church); Christian Feast Day: Corbinian; Christian Feast Day: Disibod; Christian Feast Day: Blessed Frédéric Ozanam. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1990 — Jos Buttler, English cricketer
- 1934 — Bernard Donoughue, Baron Donoughue, English academic and politician
- 1971 — Dustin O'Halloran, American pianist and composer
- 1973 — Gabriel McNair, American saxophonist, keyboard player, and composer
- 1994 — Shane Griffin, Norwegian professional footballer
- 1944 — Peter Bellamy, English singer-songwriter (died 1991)
- 1945 — Ron "Pigpen" McKernan, American singer-songwriter and keyboard player (died 1973)
- 1975 — Larenz Tate, American actor, director, and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2023 — A magnitude 6.9 earthquake strikes Morocco, killing nearly 3,000 people and damaging historic sites in Marrakesh.
- 2017 — Syrian civil war: The Syrian Democratic Forces (SDF) announce the beginning of the Deir ez-Zor campaign, with the stated aim of eliminating the Islamic State (IS) from all areas north and east of the Euphrates.
- 1988 — Yellowstone National Park is closed for the first time in U.S. history due to ongoing fires.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1994 — USAir Flight 427, on approach to Pittsburgh International Airport, suddenly crashes in clear weather killing all 132 aboard, resulting in the most extensive aviation investigation in world history and altering manufacturing practices in the industry.
- 2023 — The 2023 Rugby World Cup, the tenth men's Rugby World Cup is held in France. The opening ceremony, directed and written by Jean Dujardin, Olivier Ferracci and Nora Matthey, took place at the Stade de France in Saint-Denis, before the opening match between France and New Zealand...

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1973 — World Airways Flight 802 crashes into Mount Dutton in King Cove, Alaska, killing six people.

- 1986 — Nicholas Daniloff, a correspondent for U.S. News & World Report, is indicted on charges of espionage by the Soviet Union.
- 1962 — Last run of the famous Pines Express over the Somerset and Dorset Railway line (UK) fittingly using the last steam locomotive built by British Railways, BR Standard Class 9F 92220 Evening Star.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 252 of the year, 113 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Charles Lowder (Church of England); Christian feast day: Ciarán of Clonmacnoise; Christian feast day: Blessed Eurythimia Üffing; Christian feast day: Blessed Francisco Gárate Aranguren. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1967 — Chris Caffery, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1990 — Jordan Tabor, English footballer (died 2014)
- 1963 — Neil Fairbrother, English cricketer
- 1960 — Hugh Grant, English actor and producer
- 1982 — Graham Onions, English cricketer
- 1941 — Otis Redding, American singer-songwriter and producer (died 1967)
- 1991 — Hunter Hayes, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1964 — Aleksandar Hemon, Bosnian-American author and critic

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1988 — Vietnam Airlines Flight 831 crashes in Khu Khot, Thailand, while on approach to Don Muang International Airport, killing 76.
- 2014 — The album Songs of Innocence by U2 is digitally released at no charge to all customers of the iTunes Music Store, appearing automatically in the "purchased" section of over 500 million users worldwide.
- 2009 — The Dubai Metro, the first urban train network in the Arabian Peninsula, is ceremonially inaugurated.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2014 — The album Songs of Innocence by U2 is digitally released at no charge to all customers of the iTunes Music Store, appearing automatically in the "purchased" section of over 500 million users worldwide.
- 2001 — Ahmad Shah Massoud, leader of the Northern Alliance, is assassinated in Afghanistan by two al-Qaeda assassins who claimed to be Arab journalists wanting an interview.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar